



October 2025

CONTINUAL
PROFESSIONAL
DEVELOPMENT

Welcome to the Finance Planning monthly round-up newsletter for October 2025,

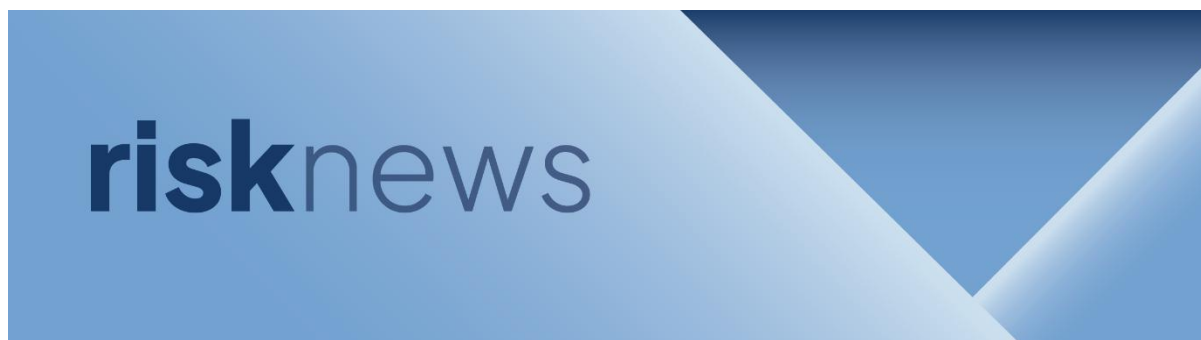
Now a month into the last quarter of the year we are gearing up for a final push before the Christmas period and with the budget due at the end of the month hopefully we will get some clarity on a few of the aspects of house buying which is making people wait before proceeding.

Despite this FPG has continued to see some really strong figures on both mortgage and protection which is testament to the very hard work that you are all putting in, so as ever we want to thank you for continuing to do such important work on behalf of your clients in a market where we are needed more than ever.

Hope everyone has a great November.

Thank you.

David



Compliance News 18/25 (New Insurer – National Friendly)

We have recently welcomed a new insurer to our protection panel. National Friendly have a range of products aimed at helping clients on a tight budget – income protection, accident only income protection, friendly shield and an over 50s life plan. They also offer PMI for the few of you who are licensed to advise on that product.

Record Keeping reminder

If you are making use of the ability to waive the record keeping requirements for Product Transfers, then you must ensure your case meets with the following criteria:

1. Did you arrange their previous mortgage? **(yes)**
2. Is the borrowing with the same lender (PT rather than re-mortgage)? **(yes)**
3. Has the repayment type of the mortgage remained unchanged? **(yes)**
4. Is the amount being borrowed increasing? **(no)**
5. Is the term (years) of the mortgage unchanged? **(yes)**
6. Is there any 'transfer of equity' or other change in ownership of the mortgage? **(no).**

And please ensure that you copy and paste these six points in to your Acre Notes page – thank you.

M Powered Mortgages

M Powered Mortgages has withdrawn from the market and have ceased to accept new mortgage applications. Where you have an application that has been offered, that offer will be honoured. Where you have a client with a completed mortgage who wishes to port and top-up then you should contact existingbusiness@mpowered.co.uk for their guidance.

Similarly, if you are unable to re-mortgage a client away from M Powered at the end of their current deal, then again, please contact that same existing business mailbox for advice.

An analysis of recent Suspicious Activity Referrals (SARs)

In the past quarter or so we have received 28 SARs, and a breakdown of these is as follows:

1. Staged Income concerns	12 instances
2. Client concerns (Fraud, PEP, Criminal)	7 instances
3. Deposit concerns	6 instances
4. Scheme Abuse or BMV	2 instances
5. Tax Evasion	1 instance

Please do be vigilant in trying to detect anything about an individual's situation or paperwork that might require further explanation or clarification. Please do challenge your clients, and ensure that you report all of your suspicions, even when you have already decided not to transact.

An analysis of recent Breaches

In the past quarter or so our breaches have been split between Acre record keeping (87%) and Data Protection (13%).

Of the record keeping breaches, please ensure you recording your advice and issuing your Suitability Report within 10 working days from your advice/application. Please also ensure you are not repeat offending, or else you might find your cases being subjected to 100% checking and/or we could fine you for your breaches.

Of the data protection breaches, we have seen three instances of client documents having been added to the incorrect case, plus two instances where we have emailed the wrong client and included some sensitive information in that email. So, please do ensure you are taking care when emailing clients, and please reply to an existing email thread where you can. Or better still, please use the secure messaging service in Acre. Finally, we had one instance where an Adviser's laptop was stolen, and here it is important that your computers are encrypted to prevent a third party from accessing your own personal data, and that of your clients.

Renters' Rights Bill

The Renters' Rights Bill received Royal Assent on 27 October, formally becoming law. The Government must now set a commencement date for when the Act's provisions will come into force. While the legislation is now on the statute books, not all measures will take effect immediately.

We consider these to be the main changes:

- **Eviction changes** – Section 21 no fault evictions have been abolished. Evictions will now be under Section 8 which includes anti-social behaviour by the tenant, the landlord wishing to sell up, or rent arrears.
- **Periodic tenancies** – or rolling contracts with no end date will replace fixed term tenancies. ASTs will convert to these period tenancies. Tenants can give 2 months' notice to leave the property.
- **Setting and collecting rent** – Landlords can only up the rent once per year, and only at the market rate.

- **Tenants in arrears** – Landlords will be required to wait longer before they can move to evict a tenant in arrears.
- **Raising standards** – Landlords will now be subject to the Decent Homes Standard and Awaab's Law, like those properties in social housing, to make sure tenants' homes are safe, good value and good quality.
- **Ombudsman to oversee fairness** – to provide tenants with a binding resolution on disputes.

Key elements of these changes, such as the Decent Homes Standard are not expected to be implemented until 2035/2036. Other parts of the Act, including the national landlord database and the new ombudsman scheme, remain without a confirmed timeline, as the Government has yet to announce when these will launch.

This period of transition offers an opportunity for us Mortgage Advisers to strengthen relationships with our landlord customers and add real value through helping landlords stay informed about when specific provisions of the Renters' Rights Act will come into effect, and what practical steps they should take to remain compliant.

With potential changes to property standards and tenancy management costs, landlords may need to restructure or refinance their portfolios to maintain profitability. By offering proactive and informed guidance, we can reinforce our role as essential partners in helping landlords navigate a shifting regulatory landscape.

Government Consultation – Home Buying and Selling Reform

This Consultation has landed, sparking much-needed debate about how we can make the process faster, fairer, and more transparent. On paper, the proposals promise much of what the sector has long called for; more upfront information, reduced fall-throughs, and greater efficiency.

Whilst our trade body, AMI, are preparing a response to the Government, it's worth considering that no amount of digitisation will truly transform the market unless buyers are financially prepared and sellers are genuinely sale-ready. As Mortgage Advisers, we have a central role to play in making this happen, helping clients enter the market informed, confident, and ready to move when the right opportunity comes along.



In July 2023, Richard Lucy arranged a mortgage and protection review for Mrs H, recommending a life policy and a modest £10,000 critical illness (CI) plan that also covered two of her children. A year later, Mrs H's daughter was sadly diagnosed with a rare blood cancer, spending several months in hospital for treatment. During a recent meeting, Mrs H mentioned the ordeal and was surprised to learn her CI policy covered her children. Richard immediately contacted Aviva to start a claim, and a payout of around £10,000 is now expected.

— helping to offset the financial strain of travel, accommodation, and lost income. Even a small policy can make a big difference when life takes an unexpected turn. Well done Richard!

NOVEMBER PROTECTION WORKSHOPS:

A reminder we have 3 fantastic sessions in November hosted by Matt and delivered by Steve Orton which will count towards 3 hours of Protection CPD. You should have received an email invite to register but if you haven't for whatever reason please contact Matt or Mark ASAP.

Session 1 – 7th November – 2pm – **Unlocking Sales Behaviours that Drive Results**

Session 2 – 14th November – 2pm – **Income Protection: The Conversation that Pays**

Session 3 – 21st November – 2pm – **Building Certainty with Trusts and Wills**

Why Shepherds Friendly?

Vicki Thomas our Shepherds Friendly BDM recently joined an FPG Monday Zoom session to share some of their USPs, its worth being aware of the below.

- Two application routes with no difference in premium 1) Full health and lifestyle application – Classically underwritten. No loadings ever applied. Exclusions can be removed after 12 months. 2) Simplified application – moratorium underwriting basis of 3 years back and 2 years forward.
- 70% income covered.
- Age costed premiums – ideal for those under 40 years old but also an effective affordability tool for clients who may be rated.
- Additional benefits at no extra cost – Nuffield Health Virtual GP and 20% discount, bereavement payment of £6,000 and new child payment of £250.



In this mortgage update we are minimising the number of product or specific criteria changes as you can review these from the vast array of emails you receive from lenders each day.

MPowered

As already mentioned in the compliance section of this document Mpowered have withdrawn from the mortgage market, please refer to Pete's notes above about existing Mpowered clients who need help porting or re-mortgaging, or to Mpowered's own correspondence if you have questions about existing applications. If you need any support at all on this news please don't hesitate to contact your Sales Manager.

HSBC

HSBC have introduced a new loan to income multiple of 6.5x for clients who qualify for their Premier range and have an LTV of 90% or less. At least one applicant must hold a premier account at the point of submission. Their affordability calculator has been improved to include these changes.

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)



Mortgages – Adviser League Table for October 2025

Congratulations to both **Rob Chart & Pratima Gurung** for topping our mortgage table in October.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Pratima Gurung	36
Rob Chart	36
Emily Chattaway	32
Paul Gent	30
Dan Fletcher	24
Jack Savory	22
Claire Lipscomb	20
Cathy Rafferty	19
Joanne Pope	19
Andy Poustie	18
Jonathan Peachey	18
Karen Mills	18
Phil Smith	17
Carl Thorne	16
Paul Ripley	16
Tim Dock	16
Chris Williams	15
Hannah Logan-Hughes	15
Phil James	15
Tony Hornby	15
Dan Grant	13
Paul Goodey	13
Pete Stickley	12
Ellis Featherbe	12
Jim Maye	12
Dipes Rai	11
Jack Humphries	11

Joe Maskell	11
Scott Sutton	11
Joe White	11
Carrie Millin	10
Dan Walsh	10
Oscar Delves	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for October 2025

Congratulations to **Paul Gent** for topping the protection table in October.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	54
Clare Mann	36
Rob Chart	21
Jane Hutchinson	18
Jack Savory	18
Petru Balan	11
Andy Poustie	11
Carl Thorne	10

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables

Should anyone feel their applications are not being calculated properly, please speak to your Sales Manager as it might mean those cases you have submitted to a lender or insurer have not been recorded as such on Acre yet and we can show you how to fix that.



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases this year. Lots of new entries this month so congratulations to all. Cases added in the last month are shown in **blue**.

Mortgage cases

Paul Goodey	£3,881,250
Romi Pal	£3,207,525
Paul Goodey	£2,544,768
Chris Williams	£2,377,875
Paul Goodey	£2,306,000
Paul Goodey	£2,131,737
Wilma Scott	£1,762,500
Paul Goodey	£1,742,815
Paul Goodey	£1,629,776
Oliver Cunningham	£1,510,450
Paul Goodey	£1,500,000
Paul Ripley	£1,462,000

Joanne Pope	£1,454,540
Victoria Worthington	£1,410,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,400,000
Romi Pal	£1,385,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,380,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,370,000
Carrie Millin	£1,335,897
Victoria Wescott	£1,300,074
Paul Goodey	£1,300,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,291,980
Wilma Scott	£1,268,688
Trevor Farley	£1,237,393
Rob Chart	£1,234,503
Mike Smurthwaite	£1,208,503
Ellis Featherbe	£1,207,000
Paul Goodey	£1,207,000
Jonathon Peachey	£1,200,000
Marion Hunnisett	£1,125,000
Emily Chattaway	£1,170,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,150,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,105,000
Joanne Pope	£1,083,660
Paul Goodey	£1,072,000
Claire Lipscomb	£1,067,698
Peter Stickley	£1,051,495
Cathy Rafferty	£1,020,000
Paul Goodey	£1,015,521
Jim Maye	£1,014,681
Karen Mills	£1,006,820
Joanne Pope	£1,005,699
Carrie Millin	£1,003,373
Paul Goodey	£1,001,054
Joanne Pope	£1,000,000
Lee Harper	£1,000,000

Protection cases

Dave Relfe	Exec IPB £3,838,800
Dave Relfe	Exec IPB £3,729,120
Wilma Scott	Life £3,526,998
Paul Gent	Life £2,400,000
Paul Gent	RLP £2,400,000
Victoria Wescott	Life £2,352,000
Paul Gent	IPB £2,339,073
Simon Maskell	Life £1,881,000
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,863,948
Simon Maskell	IPB £1,840,000
Lorraine Smith	Life £1,560,790
Ellis Featherbe	Life £1,500,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,400,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,400,000
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,240,320

Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,164,801
Paul Gent	IPB £1,128,204
Richard Lucy	Life £1,000,000
Dave Relfe	RLP £1,000,000
Dave Relfe	RLP £1,000,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,000,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,000,000
Clare Mann	RLP £1,000,000
Clare Mann	RLP £1,000,000

As with the mortgage and protection figures if you feel an application you have made should be referenced here, please speak to your sales manager to confirm if it is showing on Acre correctly.



FPG Anniversaries

So far in 2025 we have seen some very significant milestones reached in terms of service within the Finance Planning Group especially as this is the 25th year of The Finance Planning Group. A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Lee Harper – 24 years
- Dan Maskell – 23 years
- Nick Hodge – 21 years
- Marion Hunnisett – 21 years
- James Hall – 14 years
- Matt Stephens – 12 years
- Dean Aspinall – 10 years
- Victoria Worthington 5 years
- Claire Lipscomb – 5 years
- Stuart Hunnisett – 4 years
- Amit Swar - 2 years
- Binita Gurung – 2 years
- Dipes Rai – 2 years
- Pratima Gurung - 2 years
- Samita Rai – 2 years
- Smriti Pun – 2 years
- Unika Rai – 2 years
- Oscar Cornelius – 1 year

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list that should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in November.

- Aisling Oates
- Binita Gurung
- Colin Mackay
- Jonathan Peachey
- Kim Dock
- Kirstin Richardson
- Lucy Ditton
- Manita Gurung
- Peter Stickley
- Richard Saunders

Angela Yeats – Well Done!

Big congratulations to our own Angela Yeats for her 20 years of volunteering in Girlguiding.



miscellaneous

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status. We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable, please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

Escape room champions?

The FPG admin team recently spent the afternoon attempting to escape from the Bewilder Box escape rooms in Hove. Team Kirstin were self-proclaimed champions after getting out with only 59 seconds to spare...



October Zoom sessions

Here are the details of the Zoom sessions FPG hosted in October and the links to re-watch them.

01/09/2025 – Chorley & Shepherds Friendly - <https://knowledgehub.website/12-10-2025-chorley-shepherds-friendly/>

17/10/2025 – National Friendly - <https://knowledgehub.website/17-10-2025-national-friendly-special/>

27/10/2025 – Principality - <https://knowledgehub.website/27-10-2025-principality/>